illustrates this fragmented nature of the social contract, with rights becoming a luxury guaranteed only to the rich or the upper middle classes, while the rest of the citizens struggle for basic amenities. The regional disparity in relation to rights and duties is evident in the response of the student from the focus group in Lahore, quoting the example of one of the most deprived areas in Pakistan, Thar, that is suffering from severe drought, resulting in the deaths of hundreds of children.[3] The lack of response or outrage from the population, particularly in Punjab, is indicative of the general divide across provinces and socio-economic groups in Pakistan. With Islam being mainstreamed into the state structure in the three decades after independence, the nature of the social contract for religious minorities and different sects also changed. In essence, this 'social contract' was different across socio-economic class and religious groups. Like most developing nations with a colonial legacy, Pakistan struggled to provide for its large and growing population. However, in the 1950s and 1960s, Pakistan was developing fast, and due to its market economy seemed poised to make the most of a growth trajectory.

Fast-forward to today and the picture looks rather different. There is an official recognition that the 'state by definition must be strong and effective with a monopoly over the possession and employment of force and the authority and obligation for providing basic socio-economic needs and good governance to its people' (NACTA 2018, p. 4). Yet, this recognition is in relation to a counterextremism strategy that attempts to examine how and why Pakistanis turn towards terrorism. There is a realization that the weakness of the state in governance and service delivery has created a vacuum exploited by extremist elements. It took over a decade of violence in the form of terrorist attacks for the Pakistani state to even acknowledge there was a failure on its part. But this recent acknowledgement is a long way from any concrete action. The state in Pakistan had become increasingly absent. State-provided services had been declining in quality and availability for several decades. Civil society and the private sector jumped in, but given Pakistan's size and population they were unable to replace the state. Increasing numbers of lower-middle-class people and even the poor turned to the low-fee private sector to fulfil their education and health needs. As electricity, gas and water supplies became irregular, those who could afford paid for generators and water tankers. Those who could not, continue to bear the bad infrastructural conditions.[4] From time to time there are protests reminding the government that the state structures have crumbled; however, most know that protests serve little purpose as officials are largely unable to do anything about the dismal state of affairs.[5] The state, while becoming increasingly ineffective, was